Kangaroo stomach worms

☞ **1** Use the notes below to write a paragraph about the digestive system of a kangaroo.

- kangaroos eat grass but can't digest it
- their stomachs are full of long thin worms and bacteria
- the stomach worms digest the grass
- kangaroos digest the stomach worms' waste
- some people think the worms are parasites
- some people think kangaroos need the stomach worms to digest the grass
- both sick and healthy kangaroos have the worms

A **parasitic** relationship is when one organism lives off another, causing it harm. A **symbiotic** relationship is when two different organisms both benefit from their relationship and neither suffer.

☞ **2** Match the phrases below.

A parasite takes nutrients	lots of stomach worms.
The stomach worms can't	from the host.
A healthy kangaroo has	exist outside of the kangaroo.

3 Are the worms parasitic or symbiotic? List the possible evidence to support each argument.

Parasitic	Symbiotic

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